

“Savior, Who Didst Healing Give”

Text: Hardwicke D. Rawnsley, 1905

Meter: 7.8.7.8.7.8.8.8

Suggested Tune: JESUS IST DAS
SCHÖNSTE LICHT

1. Savior, who didst healing give,
still in power go before us;
Thou through death didst bid men live,
unto fuller life restore us;
strength from Thee the fainting found,
deaf men heard, the blind went seeing,
at Thy touch was banished sickness,
and the leper felt new being.

2. Thou didst work Thy deeds of old
through the loving hands of others;
still Thy mercies manifold
bless men by the hands of brothers.
Angels still before Thy face
go, sweet health to brothers bringing;
still, hearts glow to tell his praises
with whose name the Church is ringing.

3. Loved physician! For his word
lo, the gospel page burns brighter,
mission servant of the Lord,
painter true, and perfect writer.
Savior, of Thy bounty send
such as Luke of gospel story,
friends to all in body's prison
till the sufferers see Thy glory.

Reflection (Feast of St. Luke):

This hymn follows the tradition that Luke the Evangelist was a physician prior to his discipleship (cf. Col. 4:14). However, the text itself primarily speaks of Christ's role as the divine physician. Starting in the first line, the text refers to Christ as “savior” – a common title for Christ – but the meaning goes deeper than that in this hymn. The

word “savior” has roots in the Latin *salvare* (“to save”), and even beyond that in the Latin *salus* (“health, well-being”).

As the savior, we are asking Christ, the one who gives health and well-being, to go before us to cure us from our ailments. We ask Him in particular to restore us from death to abundant life (as He did with Lazarus), strengthen our weariness, cure our deafness, restore our sight, and banish sickness. While all of these things can of course be interpreted in a literal sense, since they are all things that Christ actually did (and continues to do), they can also be interpreted in a spiritual sense: curing our deafness to His word, banishing the sickness of sin, etc.

Verse 2 acknowledges that Christ's physical healings continue through the hands of physicians and healthcare specialists. But the text indicates that there is one particular physician whose praises resound throughout the Church: Luke.

The final verse speaks in praise to God for Luke, since, while he was indeed a physician, he held many other noble vocations as well, including a missionary, a “perfect writer” whose texts were inspired by the Holy Spirit, and a painter (recalling the tradition that Luke was the first iconographer). The hymn concludes with a request for God to send us more people like Luke – more people who can evangelize, write, paint, and cure physical sufferings. But physical medicines can not ultimately save us; they can not defeat death. So, we finally ask Christ to help those who suffer to see at last His glory in eternal life.